

FY26 Pricing Redesign

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Related: [Figma](#), Tech Spec, Functional Requirements

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tl;dr

The challenge today

Mailchimp's pricing experience creates significant **cognitive overload at the moment of high intent**, forcing prospects to navigate complex plan structures, dense feature comparisons, and unclear pricing logic before they've built confidence in the product. Prospects struggle to understand **how pricing scales with their business (e.g., contacts, features, add-ons)** and whether costs will remain predictable over time—one of the top pricing concerns across segments. At the same time, there isn't strong alignment between **price and value**, making it difficult for users to map plans to their specific needs or expected outcomes.

These challenges are felt across both core segments:

- **Basic marketers (60-70% of traffic)** are primarily blocked by confidence and readiness, not product gaps—**55% cite “not ready yet or not needed” as their top barrier**, and only about half report finding the pricing and plan information they need. The current pricing experience reinforces this hesitation by introducing complexity instead of clarity.
- **Advanced marketers (20-30% of traffic)** require clear validation of ROI, scalability, and integrations, yet only ~40-45% feel confident determining whether Mailchimp will work for their organization. Pricing concerns around flexibility, predictability, and scaling costs further compound this uncertainty.

Instead of reinforcing confidence, the pricing page amplifies uncertainty—leaving both Basic and Advanced prospects hesitant to commit, defaulting to lower-risk options, or dropping out of the funnel entirely.

What we'd like to test

Our goal is to redesign the pricing page from a static comparison exercise → a more guided evaluation experience, where prospects can quickly understand their options at a glance and dive deeper as needed, prioritizing clarity, speed, and confidence in decision-making.

We will test a structure that enables:

- **I can start exploring without committing:** As a prospective customer, I want a clear, low-risk way to get started (e.g., trial-first entry), so that I can evaluate Mailchimp without feeling locked into a decision.
- **I can quickly understand my options at a glance:** As a user comparing plans, I want to see simple, scannable plan options immediately, so that I can understand what's available without parsing dense tables.

- **I can go deeper only when I need to:** As a more detail-oriented or advanced user, I want to access deeper feature comparisons and nuances on demand, so that I can validate my decision without being overwhelmed upfront.
- **I understand what I'll pay and why it's worth it:** As a prospective customer, I want to clearly see how pricing scales and how each plan delivers value (outcomes, use cases, proof), so that I feel confident in both the cost and the return.
- **I know when and how to get expert help:** As a growing or mid-market business, I want clear signals that I may need a higher-tier or custom plan and an easy way to connect with Sales, so that I can choose the right solution without navigating complexity on my own.
- **I understand how Mailchimp grows with me:** As a customer exploring marketing tools, I want to understand how email, SMS, and other capabilities work together, so that I can make a complete decision without confusion and feel confident I won't outgrow the platform.

These principles bring our [detailed user stories](#) together into the key decisions we need to help customers make. Pricing should function as a **decision guide, a confidence builder, and a risk reducer**—not a static comparison table. Our core bet: If we simplify the initial pricing experience and defer complexity, we will reduce cognitive overload and increase trial starts and paid plan selection.

What we already know

- **The majority of customers are smaller and start as free:** ~80% of customers today start on the free plan vs. a free trial. The majority of our trial customers are on the 500 and 1,500 tiers, and ~60% are on Standard.
- **Trials are the default path that drive bookings but we still see significant dropoff:** While ~70% of paid bookings originate from trials, only ~30% of activated customers start with trials when the No CC trial opt-in happens during account setup.
- **Pricing is a primary entry point for high-intent prospects:** 57% of prospects visit Mailchimp.com specifically for pricing and plan information, making it one of the most critical conversion surfaces
- **Pricing clarity is insufficient at the moment of decision:** Only ~50–60% of prospects report finding all the information they need on pricing and plans, leaving a significant portion uncertain at a key conversion step
- **Trial experiences are the strongest driver of paid conversion:** ~70% of paid bookings originate from trials, making trial entry the most critical conversion lever
- **Default to free might be due to uncertainty, not intent:** Even with trials available, ~60% of new customers start on a free plan
- **Basic marketers dominate traffic but require simplicity and reassurance:** 60–70% of prospects are Basic marketers, with 82% spending \$0 on marketing tools and 55% citing “not ready yet” as their primary barrier to adoption
- **Advanced marketers require proof of scalability and ROI, which pricing fails to provide:** Only ~44% of Advanced prospects feel confident about Mailchimp's fit for their organization, particularly around integrations, scalability, and performance
- **Pricing concerns extend beyond cost to predictability and flexibility:** Advanced prospects specifically cite concerns around pricing complexity, cost scaling, and package inflexibility as key barriers to conversion
- **Prospects view signup and trials as part of evaluation, not commitment:** ~43–44% of prospects intend to create an account the same day, but treat it as a way to explore the product rather than make a purchase decision

- **Category leaders prioritize simplicity and speed over depth in initial pricing views:**
Competitors consistently lead with lightweight plan cards (<10 bullets) and defer detailed feature comparisons to expandable modules to reduce overwhelm
- **Direct-to-signup flows are becoming the category norm:** The majority of competitors route primary CTAs directly to signup or trial experiences rather than forcing users through the pricing page, signaling a shift toward trial-first PLG models

Hypothesis TL;DR

Product Hypothesis TL;DR:

If we redesign the dotcom pricing experience to prioritize clarity and confidence, then more prospects will confidently start trials and convert to paid plans, increasing new booking revenue.

- Shift users from evaluation paralysis → action
- Move users from free → paid entry
- Accelerate time to first value moment → low risk entry points

Success will be measured by:

- +X% increase in trial start rate from pricing page
- +X% increase in paid plan selection (Essentials/Standard) from pricing page
- +X% increase in mid-market MQLs
- Guardrail: no >X% decline in self-serve NB MRR

Null Hypothesis TL;DR:

Redesigning the dotcom pricing experience will not materially impact trial starts, paid conversion, or revenue, and observed friction is not a primary driver of conversion loss.

- Users who drop off would not have converted anyway (low intent)
- Pricing clarity and confidence is not the primary barrier (vs product fit)
- Low-risk entry points do not meaningfully change behavior

Opportunity

Business Goals

Our north star for the business is to drive Incremental New Bookings MRR, and we have bold goals across the activation to paid customer experience:

1. **Drive Traffic to Activations conversion improvement:** 49% conversion rate improvement (4.0% target, up from 2.7% projected in H2 due to higher intent mix shift) (Owners: Christine Kuo , Daniel Bueckman)
2. **Drive Activations to Paid Bookings conversion:** 43% conversion rate improvement (22% target, up from 15% in projected H2 & collapsing activations to conversions to bookings in one stage) (Owner: Kyle Spaulding , Anish Nahar)

Projected Impact

Projected to drive **\$TBDK** in in-year NB MRR for FY26

Customer Research

Our customer profiles, expanded

From  Prospect Needs - And What They Mean for Web Design , we see a consistent pattern:

1. Prospects are early-stage and lack category understanding

- 65% of prospects are new to the category
- 75% identify as basic marketing users
- 80% spend \$0 on marketing tools

👉 What's happening:

Users don't yet understand what they need or how Mailchimp fits into their workflow

👉 Implication for pricing:

Pricing must act as orientation and education

→ Help users answer: *"What is this and how would I use it?"*

2. Users can't predict cost or how pricing scales

- 57% of prospects visit for pricing
- Only ~50-60% find sufficient clarity
- Key concerns: scaling costs, flexibility, predictability

👉 What's happening:

Users can't clearly answer "what will this cost me now and as I grow?", leading to hesitation

👉 Implication for pricing:

Pricing must provide transparent, predictable pricing logic

→ Help users answer: *"How does this work financially?"*

3. Users lack confidence to take action (readiness gap)

Top barriers:

- "Not the right time" (52% overall, 55% Basic)
- "Not sure how it applies to my business"
- "ROI unclear"

👉 What's happening:

Users hesitate because they're unsure if they should commit right now

👉 Implication for pricing:

Pricing must reduce perceived risk and commitment pressure

→ Help users answer: *"Is it safe to try this?"*

4. Basic and Advanced users require different types of validation

Basic Marketers (60-70%)

- Need: simplicity, clear guidance, low-risk entry
- Barrier: "I don't know what to choose or how to get started"

Advanced Marketers (20-30%)

- Need: proof of ROI, integrations, scalability
- Barrier: "Will this work for my business at scale?"

Implication for pricing:

Pricing must support both:

- Fast, simple decisions (Basic)
- Deeper validation and proof (Advanced)

5. Signup and trials are part of evaluation—not commitment

- ~43-44% of prospects intend to create an account same day
- Users treat signup as a way to explore, not commit

What's happening:

Users view entry into the product as part of the buying journey

Implication for pricing:

Pricing should enable momentum and low-risk exploration, not force upfront decisions

Synthesis

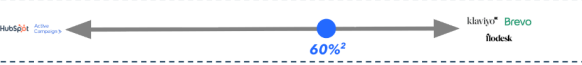
Across all segments, prospects come to pricing trying to answer three core questions:

1. **Orientation:**
→ "What is this and do I need it?"
2. **Economics:**
→ "What will this cost me and how does it scale?"
3. **Readiness:**
→ "Can I try this safely without committing?"

Competitive Benchmarking

See  260212 MC HP / PP Deep Dive.pptx for a deep dive into competitive benchmarking and opportunities identified during early ideation sessions:

PP: Starter list - various ideas to test (PRELIMINARY - FOR DISCUSSION)

	Idea	Competitive inspiration
Step-change ideas	1 Lead with plan cards + quick summary; collapse comparison table: Default to pithy plan cards and hide/preview the current long comparison table behind an "Expand" CTA	
	2 Add social proof: Incorporate high-signal trust cues (e.g., claims, testimonials, etc.) throughout the pricing page to reinforce value	
More targeted ideas	3 Make pricing prominent and clearly legible: Showcase pricing of each plan instead of "Free" being highlighted and most prominent copy	
	4 Default to annual billing (currently being driven by Anish): Start on annual pricing (with savings called out), and offer monthly toggle for those who need it	
	5 Only surface 15% off 10k+ once user over threshold: Reveal 15% discount offer only when 10k+ contacts are selected	N/A - logical suggestion to consider
	6 Change pricing dropdown to slider: Make UI more engaging (which is harder on a dense pricing page); e.g., use slider for contacts with the chimp instead of dropdown	
	7 Route homepage CTA directly to signup: Skip the pricing page detour by linking the homepage CTA into the trial signup flow	
	8 Move pricing above the fold: Rework the intro section so plan pricing is visible on initial load (e.g., bring the plan card module higher)	
	9 Test plan ordering (pricing low → high): Though against the principle of price anchoring, consider following 83% of benchmarks who order low to high, especially since we know price is a concern for most prospects and \$297.50 is the only number shown currently	

Note: 1. Klaviyo is excluded from analysis; any plan-like packaging is limited to Professional Services rather than the core product; 2. Only direct competitors considered given idea specificity to industry; 3. Klaviyo does not have a comparable pricing page (pricing is modular, so it was removed from this benchmark)

Key concepts from competitive benchmarking:

Concepts	Context
Pricing above the fold	- Examples: Brevo, Shopify, Webflow, Asana - Rationale: Reduces friction and time-to-value, increases activation by minimizing pre-price distractions
Progressive disclosures vs. dense comparison tables	- Examples: Canva → expandable feature table, Asana → "Compare all features" expansion, Constant Contact → "See all features" - Rationale: Prevents cognitive overload, supports both quick scanning (Basic users) and deep evaluation (Advanced users)
Annual default with savings callout	- Examples: Shopify → "Save 25%", Canva → "Save 16%", Monday → "Save 18%" - Rationale: Anchors perceived affordability, sets expectation of long-term commitment
Keep plan cards simple	- Examples: Webflow, Shopify, Brevo (All lead with simple plan cards + key bullets) - Rationale: Faster comprehension, better visual hierarchy, reduces cognitive overload
Guided pricing / dynamic configurators	Examples: Klaviyo → contact + SMS sliders updating price in real-time; ActiveCampaign → selectors for usage + product

	● Rationale: Helps users understand scaling costs, Increases confidence in pricing transparency, Reduces "unknown future cost" anxiety
Social proof embedded near pricing	● Examples: Shopify → "millions of merchants", Canva → "6M+ teams", Brevo → logos like Louis Vuitton ● Rationale: Reinforces trust at decision moment, Reduces perceived risk, Particularly critical for Advanced users
CTA differentiation by segment	● Examples: HubSpot: Self-serve → "Buy now" OR Enterprise → "Talk to sales"; Canva: Individual → "Get started" OR Enterprise → "Contact sales" ● Rationale: Matches user intent, avoids forcing one-size-fits-all flow
Planless / trial-first entry	● Examples: Shopify → "Start for free" without plan selection; Asana → trial without upfront plan choice ● Rationale: Removes decision friction, Aligns with PLG, Lets product demonstrate value first
ICP segmentation and personalization	● Examples: Canva → "For individuals vs teams", Webflow → "Freelancers vs teams", Monday → product-based segmentation ● Rationale: Helps users self-identify quickly, Improves perceived relevance, Reduces "is this for me?" friction

Definition of Redesign

Our approach

Our approach is iterative, modular, and experiment-driven - not a "big bang" redesign. Instead, we will design a North Star upfront, break the experience into modular components, test and iterate on individual modules, and converge toward the North Star.

A North Star gives us a clear picture of how everything can fit together to create a better experience for prospects. It is:

- A future-state vision of the pricing page experience
- A close approximation of what we aspire to ship, not a theoretical ideal
- A grounded, buildable vision that pushes boundaries without being infeasible

We will use the North Star to:

- Align cross-functional teams (Product, Design, Engineering, Marketing)
- Ensure consistency with Homepage redesign direction
- Provide a cohesive target state across all experiments
- Prevent fragmented, incremental optimization without a unifying vision

User stories

1. "Help me quickly understand what I'll pay"

As a prospective customer, I want to quickly understand how much Mailchimp will cost me now and as I grow, so that I can decide if it fits my budget.

Customer signal:

- 57% visit for pricing but only ~50-60% find clarity
- Concerns about scaling costs

Business goal impact:

- Reduce pricing page drop-off
- Improve new booking revenue via paid plan conversion

2. "Help me choose the right plan without overthinking"

As a small business owner, I want to easily understand which plan is right for me, so that I don't feel overwhelmed or default to the safest (free) option.

Customer signal:

- 60% default to free
- Basic users need guidance + simplicity

Business goal impact:

- Increase Activation to Trial Start rate
- Drive paid plan mix shift

3. "Help me feel safe trying Mailchimp"

As a new user evaluating Mailchimp, I want to try the product without risk or commitment, so that I can explore whether it works for me.

Customer signal:

- "Not ready yet" is #1 barrier (55% Basic)
- Users treat signup as evaluation
- Trial-first behavior drives conversion

Business goal impact:

- Increase Activation to Trial Start rate
- Improve new booking revenue via paid plan conversion

4. "Show me that this will work for my business"

As a growing business, I want to see proof that Mailchimp works for businesses like mine, so that I feel confident it will deliver value.

Customer signal:

- Only ~44% of Advanced users confident in fit
- Need for ROI, integrations, scale validation

Business goal impact:

- Increase conversion for higher-value segment
- Drive paid plan mix shift

5. "Help me understand how pricing connects to value"

As a prospective customer, I want to understand what I get for what I pay, so that I can justify the cost and feel confident in my decision to convert.

Customer signal:

- Weak price-to-value mapping
- ROI unclear is a top barrier

Business goal impact:

- Increase activation to trial start
- Improve new booking revenue via paid plan conversion

6. "Help me understand how pricing scales with my growth"

As a business expecting to grow, I want to understand how my costs will change as my business grows, so that I can trust that pricing is predictable and sustainable.

Customer signal:

- Advanced users concerned about cost scaling
- Fear of unpredictable pricing

Business goal impact:

- Increase conversion for larger contact tiers
- Improve new booking revenue via paid plan conversion

7. "Help me understand how Mailchimp fits into my existing stack and compares to alternatives"

As a user evaluating marketing tools, I want to understand how Mailchimp integrates with the tools I already use and how it compares to other platforms, so that I can confidently determine if it's the right choice.

Customer signal:

- Advanced prospects are significantly more likely to evaluate integrations (38%) and competitive alternatives (38%)
- Only ~43-44% feel confident in fit, comparisons, and scalability
- Integration uncertainty (12%) and switching friction (20%) are key barriers

Business goal impact:

- Increase conversion among advanced / higher-value customers
- Improve win rate in competitive consideration sets

8. "Help me understand how other capabilities (like SMS) fit into my decision"

As a customer exploring marketing tools, I want to understand how email, SMS, and other features work together, so that I can make a complete decision without confusion.

Customer signal:

- Confusion around product ecosystem
- Prospects look for email first, then consider expansion paths

Business goal impact:

→ Improve cross-sell / ecosystem revenue (SMS attach rate, Transactional attach)

9. “Help me know when I should talk to someone (and make it easy to do so)”

As a growing or mid-market business evaluating Mailchimp, I want to understand when my needs are better suited for a higher-tier plan or a custom solution—and easily connect with a Sales expert, so that I can confidently choose the right setup for my business without missing better-fit options or navigating complexity on my own.

Customer signal:

- Advanced prospects are more likely to evaluate integrations (38%) and competitive alternatives (38%), require proof of scalability, ROI, and flexibility
- Only ~43-44% feel confident in fit for their organization. Key barriers include: Integration uncertainty (12%), Switching friction (20%), Pricing flexibility and scaling concerns
- Sales-assisted customers have higher retention, are more likely to purchase Premium (higher AOV), and benefit from flexible pricing (discounts, trials, custom packaging)

Business goal impact

→ Increase mid-market MQLs (primary success metric)

→ Increase Premium plan adoption (higher AOV)

→ Improve Sales-assisted conversion rate

→ Counterbalance with self-serve NB MRR guardrail

What this redesign is:

These are illustrative examples of what we might consider in any redesign (not necessarily a list of changes to execute):

- Pricing page layout, hierarchy, and modular structure
- How plans are presented (plan cards, comparison, progressive disclosure)
- Conversion pathways (trial entry, signup flows, CTA structure)
- Integration of supporting elements (social proof, value messaging, ROI, integrations)
- Dynamic and interaction elements (contact sliders, pricing updates, personalization hooks)
- How adjacent products (SMS, Transactional Email) are surfaced within the decision flow, with Marketing being the first decision
- Competitive comparison - customers are evaluating Mailchimp in the context of competitors
- Go to market promotional strategy, inclusive of Free Trials, Introductory Promotions, Annual Plans, with the assumption that we will have to account for per market variance

What this redesign isn't:

We're focused on redesigning the pricing page experience (UX, information architecture, interaction patterns, and conversion flows)—not the underlying pricing model or packaging. This means we are not changing the core architecture of Mailchimp pricing, which includes:

- Plan structure: Free, Essentials, Standard, and Premium
- Add-on structure: SMS and Transactional require marketing plans
- Pricing model: Contact-based pricing across all plans

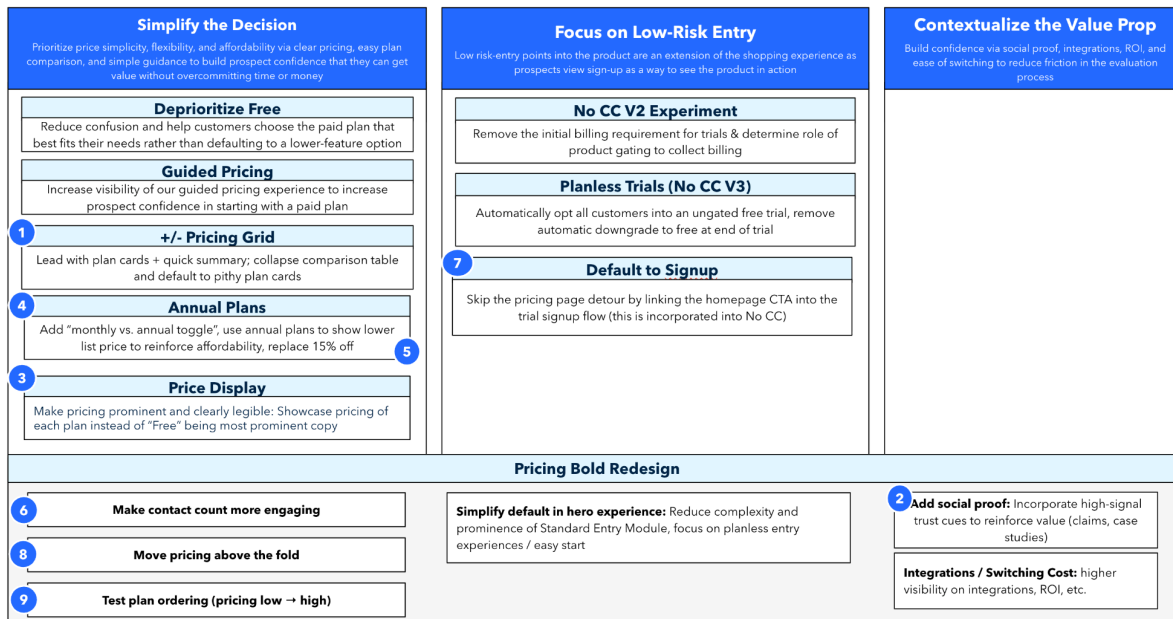
- Feature entitlements: Each plan maintains its current feature set

Two converging workstreams

These are already planned experiments tied to known customer problems and competitive gaps:

Pricing page: The ideas we're going to test

Presenter: Amanda



Hypotheses currently being tested in our roadmap:

- Simplifying plan comparison → increases paid plan selection
- Reducing prominence of Free → shifts mix toward paid
- Improved price visibility → increases conversion
- Annual pricing anchoring → improves perceived affordability
- Planless / no CC trials → increase trial starts and NB MRR

These experiments act as inputs into the North Star, helping us:

- Validate which patterns drive conversion
- De-risk major design decisions
- Identify winning components to scale

Winning experiments from Workstream 1 will be incorporated and scaled into the North Star.

Experiment Criteria

Experiment Dimension	Description
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Eligible Customers	Existing trial eligibility, which includes: Prospective customers
Ineligible Customers	All customers that are currently ineligible for the trial offer: - Existing free customers - Currently paid marketing customers - Previously paid customers who downgrade to free and are no longer marketing trial eligible - PAYGO and Legacy PAYGO customers
Activated On	Mailchimp Pricing Page
Markets	All Markets
Variant Split	TBD
Run-Time	3-4 weeks

Metrics

Success Metrics

Metric Name	Impacted User Group(s)	Current Baseline Conversion (of relevant user segment)	[Optional] Expected Changes	Actual Change
New Booking Revenue	Prospects	67% (Trial to booking rate)		

Secondary Metrics of Interest

These can include specific upper funnel feature usage, CSAT scores, and in-app feedback thumbs up/thumbs down actions, etc.

Metric Name	Impacted User Group(s)	Current Baseline Conversion (of relevant user segment)	[Optional] Expected Changes	Actual Change
Activation Rate	Prospective customers	3.26%		
Free Trial Start Rate	Prospective customers	0.90%		
	Free customers			

	within 90 days of activation			
Free Trial Retention Rate	All customers on a free trial	54.0%		
% of trial customers sending 1+ email during trial period	All customers on a free trial	62%		
% of trial booking from customers who did not send an email during a trial	All customers on a free trial	33%		
% of customers providing billing information during the trial period	All customers on a free trial	N/A		

Guardrail Metrics

Do No Harm metrics for this experiment:

Metric Name	Impacted User Group(s)	[Monthly/ Biweekly/ Weekly] Total unique users taking action	Current Baseline	Target Improvement
Account Setup Completion Rate	FTUs	~28,000 weekly	~74%; Account Setup Dashboard	Monitor for impact
FTUs who reach first payoff within 7 days	FTUs	Ecomm: ~1100 RICS: ~2100 Users creating 1+ campaigns	Ecomm: $1100/5522 = 20\%$ RICS: $2100/13648 = 15\%$ (creates/ activations)	Monitor for impact
Create to send rate (<i>email</i>)	FTUs	<u>Email</u> Ecomm: 1100/wk RICS: 2100/wk <u>CJB</u> Ecomm: 91/wk RICS: 190/wk <u>SMS</u>	<u>Email</u> Ecomm: 20% RICS: 15% <u>CJB</u> Ecomm: 1.6% RICS: 1.4% <u>SMS</u>	Monitor for impact

		Ecomm: 6/wk RICS: 9/wk source	Ecomm: 0.1% RICS: 0.1% source	
FTU Retention Rate	FTUs			

Reference links

Homepage:

- [Prototype](#)
- [FY26 Q2 Homepage Redesign Brief](#)
- [MC Homepage Phase 2](#)

Research:

- [Scaled Acquisition: Phase 1 Insights - Dec 2024](#)
- [Prospect Needs - And What They Mean for Web Design](#)

Analytics:

- [MC Funnel Template](#)
- [No CC V2 Experiment Dashboard](#)
- [Conversions Dashboard](#)

Booking Contact Size & SKU Mix

CAN					
	FY26		FY25		ITPY
Contacts	Bookings	% Total	Bookings	% Total	Bookings
500	3815	61.7%	4348	59.5%	88
1,500	1248	20.2%	1659	22.7%	75
2,500	514	8.3%	603	8.3%	85
5,000	277	4.5%	370	5.1%	75
10,000	222	3.6%	221	3.0%	100
>10,000	103	1.7%	107	1.5%	96
SKU	FY26		FY25		ITPY
	Bookings	% Total	Bookings	% Total	Bookings
Essential	2257	36.5%	2893	39.6%	78
Standard	3912	63.3%	4404	60.3%	89
Premium	10	0.2%	11	0.2%	91

LATAM					
	FY26		FY25		ITPY
Contacts	Bookings	% Total	Bookings	% Total	Bookings
500	3630	49.5%	5234	54.4%	69
1,500	1581	21.6%	1908	19.8%	83
2,500	688	9.4%	836	8.7%	82
5,000	547	7.5%	667	6.9%	82
10,000	496	6.8%	554	5.8%	90
>10,000	387	5.3%	429	4.5%	90
SKU	FY26		FY25		ITPY
	Bookings	% Total	Bookings	% Total	Bookings
Essential	2185	29.8%	2617	27.2%	83
Standard	5109	69.7%	6953	72.2%	73
Premium	35	0.5%	58	0.6%	60

- 1 LATAM has a healthier mix of contacts at ~20% >5K (vs ~10% for CAN) - deep discounts increases consideration of higher contact size but needs to be balanced with ↓ AOV impact → explore short term deep discounts
- 2 CAN 10K+ contacts saw best YoY performance (~96-100 ITPY) - driven by launch of 15% off 10K+ in Dec 2024
- 3 Premium makes up <0.5% sku mix across CAN & LATAM → explore replacing web sign-up CTA with sales CTA

Opportunities for Research

Strategic Goal

To drive Incremental MRR, our research focuses on the "moment of commitment" by identifying the business milestones that turn a browser into a Paid Trial Start.

Recruitment Strategy

To capture real-world buying behavior, our research *should prioritize active business owners and Mid-Market leads.*

We must compare how the pricing page serves two distinct mindsets:

- The "Problem-First" Mindset (High-Speed): Users landing via social or targeted ads. They need an immediate "Yes, we solve this" to commit to a trial.
 - The "Comparison-First" Mindset (High-Detail): Users landing via search or direct comparison. They need technical depth, pricing transparency, and "proof of scale."
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Recommended Research Opportunities

1. Re-aligning Value with Market Expectations

55% of Basic marketers are stalling. We need to research how to *reframe our existing tools* as immediate growth engines that users cannot afford to ignore.

- Goal: Bridge the gap between our established features and what the *modern market expects to see.*
- Lean Testing:
 - Five-Second Test: Measure if the primary ROI and "immediate benefit" of a plan are clear within seconds of landing.
 - Highlight Testing: Ask users to click the specific features on the page they feel are most worth paying for to stay competitive.

2. Proving "Immediate Edge" and Scalability

We are losing prospects who don't see us as a competitive fit for their current stage. We should test how to prove *we have the best-in-class tools for today while providing a worry-free path for tomorrow.*

- Goal: Validate that our "Tier 1" features (like AI or Automation) are perceived as *competitive essentials* rather than luxury add-ons.
- Lean Testing:
 - Feature-Gap Analysis: Have users compare our plan features directly against key competitors to identify where we are perceived as "falling behind" at specific price points.
 - Preference Testing: Compare a "future-focused" layout against a "market-competitive" layout that emphasizes how we beat the current industry standard.

3. Decoding the Mid-Market Evaluation Journey

We need to discover if these users are viewing this page as a transactional tool (to buy) or a research tool (to validate our scale). For users who require a manual quote, the pricing page may simply be a "signal of scale" before they decide to engage with Sales.

- Goal: Determine if the pricing page is the actual decision point for Mid-Market leads, or if it serves as a high-level validation step before they move to other areas of our web presence.
- Lean Testing:
 - Contextual Inquiry: Observe Mid-Market leads as they navigate the site to see exactly where they look for "proof of scale" and where they drop off.
 - Attribution Survey: Target high-volume visitors to ask: "What information would you need to see here to feel confident starting a trial today?"

4. Bridging the "Awareness and Scale" Gap

Current data shows low engagement with our secondary tabs for SMS and Transactional tools. We must research if users simply don't know these exist, or if they prefer to start with Email and scale into a multi-channel suite once they've seen success.

- Goal: Determine if surfacing these tools early builds confidence in our platform's scale or if it distracts from the immediate "Start a Trial" goal.
- Lean Testing:
 - Feature Awareness Interviews: Talk to prospects to see if they associate Mailchimp with SMS/Transactional or if they are surprised to learn we offer them.
 - Scaling Intent Testing: Discover if users prefer a "Plan-First" (buy everything at once) or an "Add-on" (start with email, grow later) mindset for their business.
 - Comparison Testing: Does seeing all our tools at once make users more confident in our ability to grow with them, or does it distract them from starting a simple email trial?

Execution & StandUps

Notes **Apr 14, 2026**

Meeting Title: Standup

Quick recap

The team met to review design options for a pricing page redesign, with Isabelle presenting three main variants (Options A, B, and C) focused on creating a more transparent and simplified pricing experience. The discussion centered around plan differentiation, particularly between Essentials and Standard plans, with concerns raised about providing enough clear differentiation to influence customer choices. Key feedback included the importance of including the free plan somewhere on the pricing page, addressing the need for better plan comparison features, and considering regional differences in how customers research pricing. The team also discussed the balance between simplification and providing enough information for customers to make informed decisions, with particular attention to mobile responsiveness and tablet sizing considerations. While no final design was selected for validation testing during this session, the team agreed to review feedback over the next 24 hours and potentially make small revisions before proceeding with testing.

Next steps

- Isabelle: Add back the free plan (de-emphasized) into the pricing page designs, ensuring it is available but not as prominent, based on team feedback.
- Isabelle: Incorporate feedback about plan differentiation, especially between Essentials and Standard, to ensure customers can easily understand the differences at a glance.
- Isabelle: Review and potentially reintroduce successful elements from earlier design concepts (e.g., lower-third free plan placement, standard recommendation clarity) into the next design iteration.
- Isabelle: Consider tablet and smaller viewport layouts in the next design iteration to ensure the contact selector and other side-by-side elements are usable across different screen sizes.
- Ryan: Dig up and share meta studies/experiments regarding the impact of social proof on pricing pages, as referenced in the discussion.
- Isabelle: Connect with Jim (and potentially Daniel and Ryan) regarding copy recommendations and testing for the new designs.

- All participants (especially engineering): Provide async feedback in Figma or via the channel on high-level feasibility of the proposed designs, focusing on whether the concepts are achievable within the 6-month North Star timeline.
- Isabelle: Post all relevant design links and feedback channels in the team's communication channel for ongoing review and comment collection.

Summary

Meeting Scheduling Time Discussion

The team discussed challenges with scheduling meetings at 5 minutes after the hour, with Sid explaining how Outlook can automatically set meetings to start at 5 minutes past the hour, while Google Calendar doesn't offer this option. Lawrence expressed a preference for maintaining some flexibility in meeting timing rather than having them automatically scheduled. The group briefly considered implementing pre-meeting social time, but ultimately decided to maintain the current approach of starting meetings at the top of the hour. Amanda concluded the discussion by noting the meeting would continue as a bi-weekly Pricing Redesign sync on Tuesdays and Thursdays.

Pricing Page Design Review

Isabelle led a design review meeting focused on selecting a pricing page design for validation testing. She outlined four key design principles: transparency, simplicity, an "easy button" concept, and positioning premium as a concierge service. The team discussed feedback from previous iterations and reviewed new designs that incorporate free trials, add-on packaging, and clear pricing information. Isabelle specified that feedback should focus on design principles rather than visual details, copy, or functionality, with the goal of selecting a design for validation testing that aligns with their "North Star" approach for the next 6 months.

Pricing Page Design Options

Isabelle presented three pricing page design options, focusing on making pricing more transparent and user-friendly. Option A featured a stripped-back version with simplified plan differentiation, while Option B included a prominent "start for free" call-to-action and a "help me choose" feature. Option C was closer to the current design, leading with premium plans and including more traditional plan comparison features. Amanda raised concerns about how customers would differentiate between similar-priced plans like Essentials and Standard in the simplified versions, while Zach and Daniel noted potential issues with making it harder for customers to see higher contact count capabilities.

Pricing Page Skimmability Challenges

The team discussed challenges with plan skimmability and comparison features on the pricing page. Zach raised concerns about differentiating between plans, particularly for users who don't want to read detailed information. Isabelle explained the current approach of having plan highlights for detailed views and suggested testing different content approaches to understand how users consume information. The team debated whether to maintain the ability for customers to set purchase intent from the pricing page versus focusing on trial-based decision making, with Amanda and Chavez supporting the option to let customers choose plans upfront. Chavez also noted the importance of considering regional differences in how users approach plan comparison and research.

Plan Differentiation Revenue Impact Concerns

Amanda raised concerns about business risks associated with plan differentiation, particularly the potential for cost-sensitive prospects to default to the Essentials plan instead of Standard, potentially reducing revenue impact. Ryan supported this point, noting that without standard entry, there would be a 20 percentage point plan mix headwind towards Essentials. Isabelle addressed Lawrence's question about the absence of a free plan in options A and B, explaining that it was intentional but could be discussed if required, and clarified that free plans were previously moved off the pricing page to reduce clutter.

Free Plan Pricing Page Discussion

The team discussed the placement and visibility of the free plan on the pricing page. Lawrence and Sid emphasized the importance of keeping the free plan available, even if de-emphasized, to maintain user access and potentially drive upgrades. Amanda shared her preference for earlier concepts that used a lower third mechanism to present the free plan without taking up significant page real estate. Levi suggested incorporating bold social proof elements, similar to competitors like Shopify, to enhance the pricing page's effectiveness over the next 6 months.

Pricing Page Social Proof Debate

The team discussed the use of social proof elements on the pricing page, with Isabelle explaining that while social proof features like email templates and business statistics were considered, they were deemed less important for a pricing page focused on high-intent users. Ryan shared research indicating that social proof on pricing pages can be a detractor rather than a helper. The team debated whether to include social proof elements like the 11 million businesses using MailChimp, with Sid suggesting these metrics might be compelling if presented effectively, while Ryan expressed concern about adding extra steps that could lose potential customers. The discussion concluded with agreement that the focus should remain on serving small businesses in the default state while potentially offering more advanced options through a toggle feature.

Pricing Page Design Options

The team discussed design options for a pricing page, focusing on tier selection and user experience. They debated different approaches, including sliders, text input, and preset options, with Isabelle presenting various design variants. The group considered factors like mobile responsiveness, discoverability of pricing information, and SEO requirements. Amanda suggested potentially needing a small revision to combine elements from different concepts. The team agreed to provide feedback on Figma within 24 hours, after which Isabelle will assess trends and determine next steps, including whether to proceed with testing immediately or revise the design first.

Notes Apr 6, 2026

Meeting Title: Standup

Quick recap

The team met to discuss updates to the pricing redesign project's two-week design sprint plan, with Isabelle proposing an extension from 10 to 12 days to accommodate additional research and testing needs. The discussion focused on addressing different user segments, particularly basic and advanced marketers, with the team clarifying that the redesign should primarily focus on self-serve conversion while incorporating sales elements only for premium tiers. Key decisions included prioritizing basic marketer needs, interspersing advanced features where possible, and ensuring the page serves different points in the customer journey for various user types. The team also discussed the need for user testing validation before finalizing the North Star design, with plans to connect with sales and research teams for additional insights and data.

Next steps

- ~~Daniel: Connect with Eric on sales enablement to gather insights on mid-market and advanced marketer needs and share with Isabelle~~
- Isabelle: Check Ask Maven and connect with Kelsey Martin to gather existing research and prospect insights relevant to pricing page redesign

- ~~Amanda: Invite Kelsey Martin to the Slack channel and facilitate sharing of any additional research artifacts~~
- Isabelle: Share updated sprint plan with the team and add to the brief
- Isabelle: Bake in at least one round of user testing before finalizing the North Star design, potentially running over the weekend
- Isabelle: Touch base with Daniel, Jim, and Amanda to coordinate on research and support needs, and sync async with Amanda on other projects to avoid timeline conflicts
- Amanda: Set up Monday, Wednesday, Friday sync meetings for ongoing progress check-ins
- Isabelle: Double check with Amanda on any hard deadlines to revise touch points in the sprint plan as needed

Summary

Pricing Redesign Project Planning Meeting

Amanda led a meeting focused on the pricing redesign project, ensuring all participants had access to the necessary materials including the project brief and high-level deck shared previously. The team's goal was to develop a two-week design sprint plan, with Isabelle and Jim set to present their refined milestones and activities.

Sprint Plan Update Discussion

Isabelle proposed updates to the sprint plan, suggesting an additional 2-3 days to address key decision points around targeting different customer segments (mid-market vs basic marketers) and defining success metrics. She outlined a work plan focusing on understanding current state, validating clarity, and developing pathways for different customer groups, with experiments planned for day 12. Isabelle noted that while the extended timeline would help buffer the project, she was open to adjusting based on team capacity and constraints.

14-Day Sprint Timeline Discussion

The team discussed a 14-day sprint timeline, with Jim clarifying that it should actually be treated as 12 working days rather than 14, accounting for weekends. Amanda confirmed that the difference between 10 and 12 days would not significantly impact the overall launch target for the first series of experiments. Isabelle confirmed that today is day one of the sprint, following the pre-kickoff meeting, and mentioned plans to run background tests with Jim's help.

Pricing Tool Design Approach

Isabelle discussed the approach for gathering information and designing a pricing tool, focusing on understanding different user groups and their needs. She emphasized the importance of defining success criteria, such as users' ability to understand costs within 5 seconds, and outlined a two-pathway approach to address varying user needs. Isabelle mentioned plans to review user stories and success states to maintain design speed and efficiency.

Pricing Page Customer Segmentation Strategy

The team discussed designing a pricing page that accommodates different customer segments, with Isabelle requesting input from the sales team to understand mid-market needs. Amanda and Sid highlighted that while advanced marketers represent 55% of new booking MRR, basic marketers make up 45% of traffic, suggesting a focus on self-serve conversion with basic marketers as the primary audience. Ryan advised focusing on self-serve

conversion rather than balancing mid-market and sales needs, with a specific sales CTA for premium tiers only. Daniel mentioned that ongoing tests are exploring ways to address advanced market requirements, though specific results timelines were not provided.

WebOps Test Planning Discussion

The team discussed plans for a WebOps test targeting premium users with 200+ contact lists to curate a specific experience and gather insights for the redesign page. Amanda and Isabelle aligned on focusing user stories around basic and advanced marketers, with basic marketers needing quick understanding of options and advanced marketers requiring deeper engagement capabilities. The discussion included clarification on market segmentation, particularly around the definition of mid-market users (25K+ contacts), and how this relates to different user skill levels and adoption stages.

Pricing Page Research Strategy

The team discussed research needs around pricing page effectiveness and customer value perception. Isabelle proposed conducting quick tests to identify what content on the current pricing page resonates with users and exploring immediate benefits and ROI messaging. Amanda suggested connecting with sales teams and the research team, particularly Kelsey Martin, to gather existing insights and artifacts from previous prospect research. The team agreed to explore resources on Ask Maven and coordinate further research efforts through their Slack channel.

North Star Project Planning Meeting

The team discussed scheduling and planning for a North Star project, with Isabelle proposing additional days to ensure smooth execution and avoid overwhelming Jim. Sid emphasized the importance of conducting user testing before finalizing the North Star, which Isabelle agreed to incorporate. Amanda confirmed they would establish structured Monday, Wednesday, Friday syncs to support the design process and ensure proper timeline management.

Design Sprint Plan UPDATED

Project Update April 9, 2026

Pricing Northstar Sprint Plan

Timeline: April 6 – April 22 (13 Working Days)

Operating Model: Solo-Led Design & Research | Consultative Copy & Engineering

Sprint Context & Strategic Adjustments

To maintain momentum and hit our April 22 target, we are adjusting our "flight plan" to account for recent shifts in resourcing, cadence, and methodology.

- **Solo-Led Execution:** We have transitioned from a two-designer model to a solo workstream. I will own end-to-end design, prototyping, and research rigging, with our copy designer moving into a consultative role.
- **Sync Cadence Shift:** To protect the "deep work" required for technical setup and solo iteration, we are moving from 30-minute M/W/F syncs to **1-hour Tuesday/Thursday review sessions**.
- **Validation-First Methodology:** We have pivoted our structure to **conduct user validation prior to finalization**. While the original intent was to create the Northstar and test afterward, we are now testing Direction A mid-sprint. This ensures our final Pricing Northstar is rooted in research findings.
- **The 24-Hour Rule:** Decisions made in Tu/Th sessions will be "locked" 24 hours later.



Revised Sprint Timeline

Day	Date	Design & Production Focus	Meeting & Consultation Cadence
Day 4	Apr 9	Deep Exploration: Iterating on marketer flows and pricing simplicity based on Wed feedback.	<i>No session today.</i>
Day 5	Apr 10	Refinement: Continue explorations; incorporate feedback/iterations.	FRIDAY SYNC (30m): CANCELED, design time needed
WE	Apr 11-12	<i>Weekend</i>	—

Day 6	Apr 13	Mid-Fi Finalization: Finalize Mid-Fi prototype; draft study script & platform check.	Copy Consult REQUIRED: Send prototype/intent copy to consultant for 24hr turnaround.
Day 7	Apr 14	Test Setup & Rigging: Build the interactive prototypes/flows for the study. (High-focus task).	TUESDAY SESSION REQUIRED: Eng Feasibility & Alignment on Direction A Test Candidate.
Day 8	Apr 15	Review: Technical QA of the rig. Launch Direction A Research Study.	Decision Window Closes: Direction A "Test Version" is locked.
Day 9	Apr 16	Direction B Exploration: Low-fidelity sketches of alternative concepts/backup plans.	THURSDAY SESSION: Pulse check on Study A / Review B sketches.
Day 10	Apr 17	Direction B Refinement: Flesh out B based on early "gut-checks" from Study A results.	Decision Window Closes: Thursday's direction is locked.
WE	Apr 18-19	<i>Weekend</i>	Data accumulation (unmoderated sessions).
Day 11	Apr 20	Synthesis: Identify core Northstar trends and winning patterns from Study A.	Analysis: Evaluate A's results against technical/business constraints.
Day 12	Apr 21	Readout Prep: Compile findings; finalize the "Winning Direction" logic.	TUESDAY SESSION: Pre-read of findings & final feedback.
Day 13	Apr 22	Visual Wrap & Delivery: Final UI pass (Pricing Northstar aligned to Homepage Northstar).	Project Handover: Final readout and documentation wrap.

Critical Workstream Notes

The Alignment Gate (Day 7)

The Tuesday session aligns the team on the **Direction A Test Candidate**. We aren't deciding the final Northstar yet; we are agreeing that *this* is the version we want to validate with users to inform our final output. Engineering will provide feasibility guardrails during this session.

Deep Dive: Test Setup & Rigging (Day 7–8)

Why this is a high-focus task: Since this is an unmoderated study (UserTesting.com), the prototype must act as a "facilitator." This requires a deep technical setup.

Research & Final Alignment Contingencies

- **Direction B Strategy:** Direction B acts as a **Strategic Contrast** in the final readout to justify the final choice and show the breadth of exploration.
- **The Pricing-to-Homepage Alignment:** The final day (Day 13) is reserved for the final high-fidelity visual pass. This ensures the **Pricing Northstar** harmonizes with the design language of the **Homepage Northstar** project.
- **Copy & Tech Pre-Flight:** Monday (Day 6) is the final window for usertesting.com permission, test setup, etc. checks and sending assets to Copy to prevent setup bottlenecks.

Research Plan - Updated April 17

North Star Pricing: Research Validation Plan

Phase 1: Foundational Discovery (Market Mindset)

Context: This phase establishes an unbiased baseline of user expectations regarding cost and value before they are influenced by our new UI. It identifies the "Price Logic" users bring to the page.

A. Jobs to be Done & Search Intent

- **The Question:** "Describe a marketing task that feels like a 'time-sink.' If a tool handled this, what would that look like in your workflow?"
 - **The Why:** Identifies the "Internal Trigger." Determines which plan features to highlight based on user pain points (Efficiency vs. Growth).
- **Secondary Question:** "What are the first 2 or 3 words or phrases you type into search to find the right fit for your business?"
 - **The Why:** Reveals if users search by Industry or Function, dictating our page headers.

B. Capabilities & Ecosystem Logic (Card Sort)

- **The Question:** "Below are 12 capabilities. Please drag each into the category that best describes its value to your business:"
 - **The Foundation:** I consider these 'Must-Haves' that should be included in a basic starting price.
 - **The Growth Engine:** I would be willing to pay extra for these as my business grows.
 - **The Luxury Tier:** These are too expensive or complex for me right now; I don't need them to get started.
 - I don't know what these are
- **The Cards:**
 - App Integrations
 - Automated Follow-ups
 - AI Send-Time Choice
 - AI Content Writing
 - Customer Segments
 - Revenue Forecasting
 - Priority Support
 - SMS/Text Marketing
 - Email Templates
 - Analytics & Reporting
 - Multi-user Access
 - A/B Testing
 - **The Why:** Validates **Plan Alignment**. Ensures pricing cards emphasize the right features for each tier based on the user's mental model.

The Card (UI Label)	The Technical Meaning	The Benefit	Pricing Context

App Integrations	API / External Connections	Connect multiple other sites and software, like your ecommerce store.	Does "connecting my store" feel like a freebie or a paid upgrade?
Automated Follow-ups	Auto-responders / Workflows	Save time and take action even when you're not actively at your keyboard.	Is "set it and forget it" the main reason they pay for a plan?
AI Send-Time Choice	Send-Time Optimization	Improve campaign performance without extra time or effort.	Tests if "AI" in the title automatically moves it to "Luxury."
AI Content Writing	Gen-AI / Copywriting	Save time and and supplement your skills on-demand	Validates if AI is now a standard expectation for a "writing" tool.
Customer Segments	Sorting / Grouping	Spot key groups in your audience so you can personalize campaigns they're more likely to respond to	Checks if they value organization or just raw volume.
Revenue Forecasting	Predictive Analytics	Predict which customers are more likely to purchase or churn, so you can take action	A classic "Pro" feature—does it feel like a "Luxury" to this segment?
Priority Support	Premium Help / CSM	Reduce downtime and get help rom a real human fast	Tests the value of speed and human access.
SMS/Text Marketing	Multi-Channel	Improve your chances of reaching a customer by coordinating between an additional channel	Clearly separates "Email" from "Other Channels" in terms of value.

Email Templates	Design Library / Assets	Save time and benefit from professional design skills	Maps to the "Manual Effort" pain point—is it a "Foundation" item?
Analytics & Reporting	Performance Dashboards	Understand how your marketing is working (and where it's not)	Is "seeing if it worked" a core requirement to get started?
Multi-user Access	Team Seats / Permissions	Expand your team	Signals the transition from a "one-person shop" to a "business."
A/B Testing	Experimentation	Test multiple versions of messages on percentage of your audience, then send the best one to the larger group	Tests if beginners value optimization or if it's "too advanced" for now.

- **Priority Question:** "Which of these is the most important for you to connect to your marketing tool? Choose the one you rely on most to run your business:"=
 - **Where I get paid** (e.g., my online store, booking system, or payment app)
 - **Where I find new people** (e.g., social media, sign-up forms, or ads)
 - **Where I create my work** (e.g., design apps, my website, or photo tools)"
 - **The Why:** Moves from Feature-First to **Value-First** thinking.

C. Scaling, Safety, & Transparency

- **The Question:** When you look at a pricing plan, what specific information helps you feel sure about exactly what you will pay today and how that cost might change as your business grows?
 - **The Why:** Defines **Transparency** for beginners and reveals if they understand tiered scaling.
- **The Question:** "When you see a price labeled as 'Starting at \$10/mo,' what is your immediate reaction? Does that give you enough information to start a trial, or do you feel you need to see your 'exact' total first?"
 - **The Why:** Directly tests the **Momentum Hypothesis** (low friction entry) vs. the **Precision Requirement** (exact cost calculation).
- **The Question:** "When you are about to sign up for a free trial, what specific words or small details do you usually look for to feel 100% safe clicking that button? What makes you feel sure there are no hidden costs or future commitments?"
 - **The Why:** Identifies "Safety Net" requirements (e.g., "No Credit Card Required").

Phase 2: North Star Validation (UI Stress-Test)

Context: A comparative study testing the current Control against three "Vision" designs. We are evaluating the trade-off between **Immediate Momentum** and **Price Precision**.

T1: Instinctive Choice (The "Easy Button")

- **The Prompt:** "Look at the layout and styling. Based on the headers and visual cues, which plan feels like the best 'fit' for your business right now?"
 - **The Why:** Tests if **Visual Hierarchy** guides users to the right plan without heavy reading.

T2: Cost Confidence (The "Decision" Test)

- **The Prompt:** "You currently have 5,000 customers. Looking at this page, do you feel you have enough information about the cost to confidently start a free trial right now?"
- **The Measurement: Confidence Score** (Yes/No) and **Information Sufficiency** (Qualitative).
 - **The Why:** This measures if users are willing to defer exact pricing until after they have "gotten in," or if the lack of an exact total is a hard "Stop" signal that kills momentum.

T3: Commitment Check (Risk Assessment)

- **The Prompt:** "On a scale of 1 to 7, does this trial feel like a 'low-risk test' or a 'high-stakes commitment'? Why?"
 - **The Why:** Measures **Psychological Safety** and the effectiveness of our trial micro-copy.

T4: The Utility Test (Semantic Inclusion)

- **The Prompt:** "Based on terms like 'Booking' or 'E-comm' in the plan descriptions, how certain are you that this platform connects with your current tools? What wording helped?"
 - **The Why:** Validates if broad categories can replace logos to reduce cognitive load and prevent industry-specific alienation.

T5: High-Volume Path (Advanced Segment)

- **The Prompt:** "Imagine you have 250,000 contacts and complex requirements. What would be your very first step to get started?"
 - **The Why:** Ensures Mid-Market users don't perceive the platform as a **"starter tool"** that lacks the sophistication required for their scale.

The Master Synthesis Scorecard

User Story	Core Metric	Control	Design A	Design B	Design C
5: Value	Motivation to Trial (Avg 1–5)				
Momentum	"Enough Info to Start" (%)				

2: Selection	"Easy Button" Alignment (%)				
3: Safety	"Low-Risk" Sentiment (1–7)				
4 & 9: Fit	"Built for Me" Rating (1–5)				
7 & 8: Stack	Ecosystem Confidence (Qual)				
Intent	% Expecting "No CC Required"				

From Research to Design: Output Mapping

- **If users prioritize "Momentum" over "Precision":**
 - **Action:** Adopt the "Simplified Entry" model. Move the contact-calculator to post-signup onboarding to maximize trial starts.
- **If users fail to find themselves in "Product-Selling" language:**
 - **Action:** Pivot Information Architecture to "Functional Headers" (e.g., *Audience Reach* vs. *Revenue Sync*) to capture diverse industries.
- **If the "Plan Alignment" score is low (users pick the wrong plan):**
 - **Action:** Redesign the visual hierarchy to better differentiate "Essentials" vs. "Standard" using color-coding, etc.
- **If users cannot verify their tech stack (Ecosystem) through text alone:**
 - **Action:** Introduce Social Proofing/visual clusters (e.g., Shopify, Instagram) beneath functional category descriptions to provide an immediate visual "Match."

Recruitment & Audience Parameters

Goal: To ensure the data reflects our "Target Growth" segments.

- **Sample Size:** n = 35 to 40 total participants (split across Phase 1 and Phase 2).
- **Participant Profiles:**
 - **The "First-Timer":** Small business owners or creators who do not currently use a dedicated marketing automation tool.
 - **The "Switcher":** Users currently using a competitor's entry-level plan but feeling limited by complexity or pricing "gotchas."
- **Screening Criteria:**
 - Must be responsible for making or influencing software purchase decisions.
 - Must have a customer/subscriber list size between 0 and 10,000 (to focus on the beginner-to-intermediate scaling logic).

- Exclusion: Full-time marketing agency professionals or enterprise-level CRM managers.

Card Name	Technical Feature	Mapping Logic
External Connection	API / Webhooks / Integrations	Beginners often don't know what an "API" is, but they know they need their tools to "talk" to each other. This tests if the ecosystem is a basic right or a premium upgrade.
Follow-up Magic	Auto-responders / Workflows	"Workflows" sounds like a chore; "Magic" sounds like a solution to the manual "dread" they described in Part A. This validates the value of automation.
Perfect Timing	Send-Time Optimization (AI)	Instead of "AI-driven heuristics," we focus on the benefit: reaching the customer at the right moment. This identifies if AI logic is seen as a "Pro" feature.
Writing Assistant	Gen-AI / LLM Copywriting	Everyone knows what a "Writing Assistant" is. This tests if users expect AI support to be included in the "Foundation" or if it's still a "Growth" add-on.
Smart Sorting	Dynamic Segmentation	"Segmentation" is a high-level marketing term. "Smart Sorting" implies the tool is doing the work for them to keep their list organized.

Growth Predictor	Predictive Analytics / CLV	"Luxury Tier" anchor. It tests if the beginner segment even wants high-level data forecasting or if it's too far ahead of their current needs.
Expert Support	Priority Support / Dedicated CSM	This identifies if human intervention is a "Safety Net" for beginners or a "Premium Service" for those with higher budgets.
Multi-Channel	SMS / Push / Omni-channel	"Omni-channel" is jargon. "Multi-channel" simply tells them they can reach people in more than one place (Email + Text).
Design Library	Asset Management / CDN	For someone who "dreads" design, a "Library" is a high-value asset. This tests if aesthetic support is a "Must-Have."
Performance Reports	Analytics / ROI Dashboards	"Analytics" can be intimidating. "Performance Reports" sounds like a digestible summary of what happened.
Team Access	Multi-seat / RBAC	Rather than "Role-Based Access Control," we ask if they need their team to help. This flags the jump from solopreneur to a small agency.
Testing Tools	A/B or Multivariate Testing	We move away from the statistical "A/B" language to see if they value experimentation as a way to grow.

Phase 2: Design A

(DESIGN A) Phase 2 Testing Plan REVISED April 24

Revised testing plan to launch preliminary validation testing on designs shown during Mailchimp weekly. The test has been formatted to further understand this designs current hypothesis

Prototype:

<https://musical-halva-152bca.netlify.app/>

Intro:

About the test:

This test is 9 questions and will take less than 15 minutes. You will be provided a design to talk about out loud while looking/interacting with, depending.

How to approach this test:

Imagine you have a list of people you need to contact for your business. You are looking at a pricing page to understand if this tool is a good fit for your business and budget.

When you are ready, continue to the first question.

Questions

1. Look at this page for a moment. Based on what you see, which plan feels like the best 'fit' for your business right now? Why?
Note: you should be seeing a design. This is the same link/design for all the following questions.
2. Looking at these plans, can you describe what the main difference is between them? Which words or phrases helped you understand what you are actually getting?
3. Looking at the pricing plans, you'll see a section for numbers. In your own words, what is being counted here? What does that term mean to you?
4. How would you explain the price difference between 'Standard' and 'Essentials' to a partner or colleague? What specific words on the page helped you explain it?
5. Imagine you are stuck between the Essentials and Standard plans. Use the information on this page to find one big difference between them that isn't the price. How easy was that to find?
6. You have 5,000 customers. Show me how you would find the exact price for your list size. Once you find it, how certain are you that this is what you'll actually pay?
7. You just used the slider to set your price. What exactly were you counting when you moved that bar? People? Email addresses? Something else?
8. On a scale of 1 to 7, does this trial feel like a 'low-risk test' or a 'high-stakes commitment'? Why?
9. Imagine your audience is now 250,000 deep. Looking at this page, how would you start the process of signing up? What would you do first?

Phase 2: Designs B + C

Design B Testing:

Prototype:

<https://16cfa830ca3849cc80a674c551228cfc-main.builderio.xyz/pricing-v28>

Intro:

About the test:

This test has 10 questions and will take less than 15 minutes.

You will be provided a design to talk about out loud. When you click the link, there will be a notice “Built with Builder...”, this means you are in the right place.

How to approach this test:

Imagine you have a list of people you need to contact for your business. You are looking at a pricing page to understand if this tool is a good fit for your business and budget.

When you are ready, continue to the first question.

Questions

1. Look at this page for a moment. Based on what you see, which plan feels like the best 'fit' for your business right now? Why? (*Note: When you click the link, there will be a notice “Built with Builder...”, this means you are in the right place.*)
2. Looking at these plans, can you describe what the main difference is between them? Which words or phrases helped you understand what you are actually getting?
3. Looking at the pricing plans, you'll see a section for numbers. In your own words, what is being counted here? What does that term mean to you?
4. How would you explain the price difference between 'Standard' and 'Essentials' to a partner or colleague? What specific words on the page helped you explain it?
5. Imagine you are stuck between the Essentials and Standard plans. Use the information on this page to find one big difference between them that isn't the price. How easy was that to find?
6. You have 5,000 customers. Show me how you would find the exact price for your list size. Once you find it, how certain are you that this is what you'll actually pay?
7. If you send five different emails to every person in your 5,000-person list this month, does that change the number you selected here? Why or why not?
8. Based on your last answer, what exactly are you being charged for here? Is it the number of people on your list, the number of emails you send, or something else?
9. On a scale of 1 to 7, does this trial feel like a 'low-risk test' or a 'high-stakes commitment'? Why?
10. Imagine your audience is now 250,000 deep. Looking at this page, how would you start the process of signing up? What would you do first?

Design C Testing:

Proto: https://a09b8f902635430e87fd7185aca20bd2-main_v2.projects.builder.my/

Intro:

About the test:

This test has 10 questions and will take less than 15 minutes.

You will be provided a design to talk about out loud. When you click the link, there will be a notice “Built with Builder...”, this means you are in the right place.

How to approach this test:

Imagine you have a list of people you need to contact for your business. You are looking at a pricing page to understand if this tool is a good fit for your business and budget.

When you are ready, continue to the first question.

Questions:

1. Look at this page for a moment. Based on what you see, which plan feels like the best 'fit' for your business right now? Why? *(Note: When you click the link, there will be a notice “Built with Builder...”, this means you are in the right place.)*
2. Looking at these plans, can you describe what the main difference is between them? Which words or phrases helped you understand what you are actually getting?
3. Looking at this page, you'll see a section with numbers (like 500, 2,500, etc.). In your own words, what is being counted here? What does that term mean to you?
4. How would you explain the price difference between 'Standard' and 'Essentials' to a partner or colleague? What specific words on the page helped you explain it?
5. Imagine you are stuck between the Essentials and Standard plans. Use the information on this page to find one big difference between them that isn't the price. How easy was that to find?
6. You have 5,000 customers. Show me how you would find the exact price for your list size on this page. Once you find it, how certain are you that this is what you'll actually pay?
7. If you send five different emails to every person in your 5,000-person list this month, does that change the number you selected here? Why or why not?
8. Based on your last answer, what exactly are you being charged for here? Is it the number of people on your list, the number of emails you send, or something else?
9. On a scale of 1 to 7, does this trial feel like a 'low-risk test' or a 'high-stakes commitment'? Why?
10. Imagine your audience is now 250,000 deep. Looking at this page, how would you start the process of signing up? What would you do first?

UT Copy Testing

Pricing Page: Copy Test Plan – Usertesting.com – April 27

UserTesting.com · Unmoderated · Quick Qual Insights

Pricing Northstar — Plan Card Copy Study

Study type: Unmoderated website test
Participants: 10-15
Session length: 20–25 min
Tasks: 9 total (Q1–Q9)
DRI: Daniel Rocha · Jim McCaffery

Research Objectives

This study focuses on whether the copy and content on the pricing page gives prospects what they need to confidently choose a plan. Specifically, we want to uncover:

- **Plan differentiation:** Can prospects clearly articulate what makes each plan distinct — and who it's designed for — based on the copy alone?
- **Feature persuasiveness:** Which feature bullets are most likely to drive plan consideration or upgrade intent, and which feel like table stakes?
- **Content hierarchy:** Is the right information surfaced at the right moment — in the plan cards, Plan Highlights, and feature grid — or are prospects missing key context when they need it most?
- **Clarity and comprehension:** Are there features or labels that feel jargon-heavy, confusing, or hard to translate into real-world value?
- **Content gaps:** What information are prospects looking for that isn't currently on the page — and what would make them more confident in their decision?

Study Approach

Qualitative and directional — no control condition. Since we're looking for copy and content signals to guide the prototype direction, this isn't a measurement study. Findings will inform what's worth testing in a future A/B.

We're using a mix of the designed prototype and text-only cards. The prototype gives participants real page context; the text-only cards let us hear reactions to copy without visual design getting in the way.

Stimulus	Description	Used in Tasks
Stimulus A: Full Prototype	Updated pricing page with revised copy. Used for browse, clarity, and decision tasks.	Q1, Q7, Q8, Q9
Stimulus B: Hero H1 Variations	3 headline variations shown side-by-side, isolated from the rest of the page.	Q2

Stimulus	Description	Used in Tasks
Stimulus C: Feature Ranking Cards	One text-only card per plan — Essentials, Standard, Premium — each with 10–11 feature bullets. Shown sequentially.	Q3, Q4, Q5
Stimulus D: Feature Grid Screenshot	Static image of the feature grid section showing plan comparison by category tab.	Q6

Stimulus C — Feature Ranking Bullets Per Plan (draft)

Essentials — \$13/mo

- Schedule emails in advance
- Remove email service branding from your campaigns
- Get emails with forms and landing pages
- Test out emails before sending
- 24/7 email and chat support
- Up to 3 seats (vs 1 on free) to work
- Send more emails — up to 10x your contact count
- Organize your subscribers into multiple audiences
- Access to hundreds of professionally designed templates
- Apply custom branding and colors to campaigns
- Add up to 50,000 contacts for growing businesses

Standard — \$20/mo

- Send emails and SMS automatically
- Sync your social media, store, and more
- Use AI tools to create emails and SMS
- Find which of your customers are most likely to spend — or churn
- Get always-on automations to do the work for you
- Automatically select the best time to send emails
- Send more emails — up to 12x your contacts
- Track your marketing performance with more powerful tools
- Use smart targeting to spot your most engaged or active customers
- Scale your business with more audiences, more users, and more seats

Premium — \$350/mo

- Your own dedicated account partner
- Done-for-you setup and migration
- Priority phone support
- Advanced revenue attribution and ROI reporting
- Unlimited team seats for unlimited growth
- Test multiple emails against each other, then send the best one
- Unlimited audiences for sophisticated marketing strategies
- Highest send limits (~15x contacts or custom scaling)
- Advanced segmentation at scale, with the ability to use more options and more data
- Custom-coded templates & deeper personalization control
- Enterprise-grade features & full platform access — every tool unlocked

9 Tasks

Introduction:

Imagine you're looking for a marketing solution for your business. You've landed on this pricing page for a product you're considering. Browse the page normally and think out loud as you go. Share whatever comes to mind.

 Stimulus A — Full prototype

Enable screen + audio recording. Watch where they pause, re-read, or skip. No time limit.

Hero + Headline

Written Response

Hero variations

Consider the large headline at the top of the page, along with a few different possible headlines. Which would be most compelling or persuasive to you? Which would be the least? Why?

 Stimulus B — Hero H1 variations, side by side

Feature Ranking — Essentials

3

Ranking

Essentials persuasiveness

There are three plan types for this platform: Essentials, Standard, and Premium. We're going to look at a list of 10 selling points for each. Which features would be most likely to persuade you to choose that plan? Please rank them from most to least persuasive. First, we'll look at Essentials.

 Stimulus C — Essentials feature card

Feature Ranking — Standard

4

Ranking

Standard persuasiveness

These ten points are features of Standard. Think about which features would be most likely to persuade you to choose Standard. Please rank them from most to least persuasive.

📌 Stimulus C — Standard feature card

Feature Ranking — Premium

5

Ranking

Premium persuasiveness

These ten points are features of Premium. Think about which features would be most likely to persuade you to choose Premium. Please rank them from most to least persuasive.

📌 Stimulus C — Premium feature card

Feature Grid

6

Multiple Choice

Grid categories

Take a look at the grid of features per plan and consider the categories at the top — Time Savers, Finding Leads, etc. We've included an image of this section. Which categories are you interested in?

📌 Stimulus D — Feature grid screenshot

Clarity

7

Written Response

Jargon / comprehension

Did any of the features or descriptions on the page feel hard to understand or jargon-y? If you can, which ones stood out to you?

📌 Stimulus A — Full prototype

8

Written Response

Plan differentiation

Consider the three plans (Essentials, Standard, Premium). Which kind of person or business do you think each plan is meant for? Describe the person or business for each plan.

 Stimulus A — Full prototype

Closing

9

Written Response

Gaps

Is there any information missing from this page that you feel you would need to make an informed decision about signing up? Is there any missing information you feel you would need to choose one of the three plans?

 Stimulus A — Full prototype



UT Setup Checklist

Before Launch

- Select saved audience: **(COPY) Prospect, marketing beginner to intermediate**
- Finalize feature bullets per plan (Stimulus C — 3 cards)
- Export hero H1 variations from Figma (Stimulus B)
- Export feature grid screenshot (Stimulus D)
- Confirm prototype URL (Stimulus A)
- Set to 5–8 participants, 20–25 min
- Enable screen + think-aloud recording

Task Order

- **Q1** — Think-aloud browse (A)
- **Q2** — Hero H1 variations (B)
- **Q3** — Essentials ranking (C)
- **Q4** — Standard ranking (C)
- **Q5** — Premium ranking (C)
- **Q6** — Feature grid categories (D)
- **Q7** — Jargon / clarity (A)
- **Q8** — Who is each plan for (A)

- **Q9** — What's missing (A)